

Animal Health Committee's key animal health policies. These are developed by AHC Member and Observer organisations and endorsed by AHC.

Disease surveillance and diagnostics

Sending biological samples overseas

Salmonella Enteritidis monitoring

National Animal Health Diagnostics Business Plan

- [National Animal Health Diagnostics Business Plan 2021-2026 \(PDF 1.1 MB\)](#)
- [National Animal Health Diagnostics Business Plan 2021-2026 \(DOCX 1.04 MB\)](#)

Aquatic animal reportable diseases criteria

- [Listing criteria for national list of reportable diseases of aquatic animals \(PDF 255 KB\) - 2020](#)
- [Listing criteria for national list of reportable diseases of aquatic animals \(DOCX 55 KB\) - 2020](#)

How to report incidents of national interest

- [Reporting incidents of potential national interest \(PDF 219 KB\) - 2018](#)
- [Reporting incidents of potential national interest \(DOCX 56 KB\) - 2018](#)

If you have difficulty accessing these files, visit [web accessibility](#) for assistance.

Hendra virus testing

Trade and market access

Live aquatic animals

Abalone health accreditation

- [Recommendations for Enterprise Level Abalone Health Accreditation Program \(PDF 373 KB\) - 2014](#)
- [Recommendations for Enterprise Level Abalone Health Accreditation Program \(DOCX 103 KB\) - 2014](#)

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Bait and berley guidelines

Disease control and management

Domestic poultry and wild birds

- [National Newcastle disease management plan](#) (Animal Health Australia 2020)

Prohibited pig feed

- [Prohibited Pig Feed Compliance and Awareness Project](#) (Animal Health Australia 2020)

Ruminant feed ban

- [Australian ruminant feed ban national uniform guidelines 2023-24](#) (Animal Health Australia 2023)

Transmissible spongiform encephalopathies (TSE)

- [Protocol for the management of designated zoo animals imported from countries at risk for transmissible spongiform encephalopathies \(TSES\) \(PDF 863 KB\)](#) (Animal Health Australia 2016)

Ehrlichia canis in dogs

- [National approach to Ehrlichia canis \(E. canis\) management \(PDF 238 KB\)](#) - 2021
- [National approach to Ehrlichia canis \(E. canis\) management \(Word 55 KB\)](#) - 2021

Ehrlichia canis definition

- [National case definition for infection with Ehrlichia canis \(Ehrlichiosis in canines \(PDF 269 KB\)](#) - 2021
- [National case definition for infection with Ehrlichia canis \(Ehrlichiosis\) in canines \(Word 56 KB\)](#) - 2021

Japanese encephalitis case definition

- [Japanese encephalitis in animals case definition 2024 \(PDF 235 KB\)](#)
- [Japanese encephalitis in animals case definition 2024 \(Word 87 KB\)](#)

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Emergency animal disease preparedness and response

- [National H5 high pathogenicity avian influenza guidelines for veterinarians \(PDF 1.3 MB\)](#)

- National H5 high pathogenicity avian influenza guidelines for veterinarians (DOCX 5.6 MB)
- Guidance for response plans in the event of an outbreak of H5 High Pathogenicity Avian Influenza in wildlife (DOCX 225 KB) - June 2026
(This is a guidance document only. Lead government agencies will implement response activities appropriate to the circumstances of any outbreak).
- Avian influenza vaccination pilot studies in non-poultry species (PDF 321KB) - 2026
- Avian influenza vaccination pilot studies in non-poultry species (DOCX 77KB) - 2026
- Avian influenza vaccination policy for rare, protected and valuable avian species (PDF 303 KB) - 2025
- Avian influenza vaccination policy for rare, protected and valuable avian species (DOCX 81 KB) - 2025
- National policy and arrangements for the engagement of private veterinary practitioners in an EAD response - 2023
- AUSVETPLAN manuals (Animal Health Australia)
- Testing arrangements and cost sharing of diagnostic testing expenses during an emergency animal disease response (PDF 231 KB) - 2025
- Testing arrangements and cost sharing of diagnostic testing expenses during an emergency animal disease response (DOCX 81 KB) - 2025

Not all the above documents were prepared by the department and may therefore fail to meet accessibility standards. For assistance and more information contact the AHC Secretariat at ahc@aff.gov.au.

Source: <https://www.agriculture.gov.au/agriculture-land/animal/health/committees/ahc/animal-health-policies>